

MP-117: Experimental and Investigational Services

Bellcourt Medical Policy | Version 1 | Status: ACTIVE | Effective for dates of service 2024-01-01 until superseded

Field	Value
Policy number	MP-117
Service code(s)	(applies across services)
Applies to	All clients administered by Bellcourt unless the client's plan document or delegation addendum states otherwise
Owner	Clinical Policy Committee
Version	v1

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out the clinical criteria Bellcourt reviewers use to decide whether the service described in this policy (Experimental and Investigational Services) is medically necessary. It is applied to prior authorization requests where the date of service falls within the effective period stated above. A client's plan document may exclude this service or impose additional requirements; plan provisions are checked first.

2. Definitions

Medically necessary: services that are appropriate and consistent with the diagnosis, in accordance with generally accepted standards of medical practice, and not primarily for the convenience of the member or provider.

3. Coverage criteria

Definition applied across all services:

- 1 A service is investigational when it lacks final FDA approval for the indication, OR peer-reviewed evidence is insufficient to show improved health outcomes, OR it is not accepted as standard of care by the relevant specialty society.

4. Not medically necessary / limitations

- Investigational services are excluded from coverage under every plan Bellcourt administers. A denial on this basis is a coverage (benefit) determination rather than a medical-necessity determination, but it must still cite this policy and the service-specific policy.

5. Documentation requirements

Not applicable.

If required documentation is missing, the request must be pended and the provider contacted for information. It must not be denied for lack of documentation until the information request has gone unanswered within the regulatory timeframe.

6. Version history

Version	Effective	Summary
v1	2024-01-01	Initial version.